righteousness of the cause for which the Indian soldiers were fighting. This was not the case in respect of the Pakistan Army, as has been very aptly put across by Shireen Mazari in her book, *The Kargil Conflict:*

> The information war was lost from the start because of the decision not to inform the public at home and an equally half-hearted approach regarding what to give out to the international community.[10]

General Musharraf's lies have been exposed by the honours and awards announced by Pakistan after the war concluded. There were two Nishan-e-Haider (equivalent of our Param Vir Chakra), twenty-five Sitara-e-Jurrat, thirty-two Tamgha-e-Jurrat and many other awards given to Pakistan Army officers and soldiers. Captain Karnal Sher Khan was killed while leading a counter-attack to recapture Tiger Hill, which was about 5–6 kilometres inside our territory. He was awarded the highest gallantry award by Pakistan. Was his action in support of the mujahideen or as a Pakistani soldier masquerading as a freedom fighter?

In his book *In the Line of Fire*, Musharraf avoids talking of the number of casualties taken by the Pakistan Army. According to one estimate, the Pakistan Army suffered 772 fatalities. These included sixty-nine officers and seventy-six soldiers from the SSG. Over a thousand were wounded, while eight were captured alive by our troops.[11] Bodies of over 200 of their soldiers were left behind in Indian territory, lying in the open or partly covered by stones. These were then buried as per Islamic rites by Indian troops, as the Pakistanis did not make concerted efforts to take them back! They specifically asked for the return of the bodies of three officers only, including Captain Karnal Sher Khan and Captain Taimur Malik, which was done by us. This will be recorded as an extremely shameful episode in their military history. (In 2010, the Pakistan Army released names of 453 officers and men who died in the Kargil war. This figure is believed to be on the lower side.)

One more lie trotted out by the Pakistanis was that the LoC was vague in the Kargil sector. Even a Pakistani map captured during